

We'll Talk In The Morning

By

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1 EXT. LONDON SIDEWALK - NIGHT

1

BETH, early-20s, American, short with long brown hair and a child-like face, runs to her apartment. THOMAS, mid-20s, British, tall and lanky, blond hair with a strong frown, follows close behind.

THOMAS
Beth, just stop!

Beth reaches their building, running up the metal stairs and charging inside. She slams the door, it catches on Thomas' hand.

THOMAS
Shit, Bethy!

Their bedroom door slams as Thomas races inside. Thomas bangs on the door and jiggles the handle to no avail.

THOMAS
She was just asking me something. I promise, Beth. It isn't like last time. It's fine. Let me in, Beth.

Silence.

2 INT. BETH AND THOMAS' BEDROOM - NIGHT

2

Only a small bedside lamp illuminates the small. Papers, clothes, and various other things litter the floor. The bed unmade and the curtains drawn. A large mirror, cracked at the bottom, leans against the wall.

Beth sits on the edge of the bed, near the window, her cellphone to her ear.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)
Beth, what happened?

BETH
Nothing happened, Mom. I need a little space. This apart--*flat*, is so small.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)
I told you not to go out there on some internet-fueled whim, with the assumption that everything would be a fairytale. Not meeting him first, in *person*, wasn't smart, Bethany. Not at all.

(CONTINUED)

Beth doesn't speak.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)

Now you tell me you're happy, but you always seem to want a way out. This time, it's visiting me? That's not gonna work. Tell me something I can believe. Give me a reason--

BETH

We're explosive! Thomas and I fight all the time. I don't know what to do, or how to fix it. I know this can work, I just don't know how.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)

You're fighting? What kind of fighting?

Beth slides off the bed, her knees to her chest.

BETH

We yell a lot. I even lost my voice a couple months back, that's why I sounded like a zombie on your birthday.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)

Is it anything more than yelling?

Beth thinks for a moment.

BETH

No. No, of course not.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)

You really want to come home?

BETH

Every time I think of leaving I get this knot in my throat. It's like a fist lodged in my windpipe. It's like walking out the door will suffocate me.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)

Then why are you calling me in the middle of the night saying that you're coming home when you know you're not?

(CONTINUED)

BETH
(crying)
I just want us to work.

Her mother pauses for a long moment.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)
Go talk to Thomas. Your dad and I
will come up with something and
I'll call you back in the
morning--our morning.

BETH
Don't tell dad that Thomas and I
are fighting. I don't want him to
get angry--you know how he is.

BETH'S MOM (V.O.)
We'll talk in the morning.

Beth hangs up. She walks to the door and presses her ear
against it. Silence.

3 INT. KITCHEN - NIGHT

3

Brown and cream colored cabinets line the narrow space, with
an open window at the back. One of the bulbs in the light
fixture on the ceiling has gone out, but the other two
remain. Grime coats the old-fashioned stovetop, but the
counters have been wiped down and clean dishes dry in the
rack beside the sink.

Thomas leans against the sink his shoulder slumped. He takes
a swig from a whiskey bottle as Beth walks in.

BETH
Seriously?

She grabs for the bottle but Thomas dodges her, lifting it
over his own head.

BETH
Give it to me, Thomas. Stop acting
like a child.

Thomas holds up his bleeding hand, now wrapped in a rag.

THOMAS
Says the girl who locked herself in
a bedroom and called her mother.

(CONTINUED)

BETH

You're such a prick. Give me the bottle.

THOMAS

Fuck off.

He takes another swig.

BETH

Stop it, Thomas!

THOMAS

Stop freaking out over nothing, Beth.

BETH

Oh, so you making out with your ex-girlfriend is nothing?

(backing up)

Gotcha. Yeah, of course!

THOMAS

We weren't making out! She just wanted to talk to me. She would've made a fuss if I ignored her.

BETH

Yeah, that conversation looked pretty damn difficult. You know, with your lips glued to hers.

THOMAS

Give it a rest, for fuck's sake, Beth. She's nothing.

BETH

You do realize this is the same girl that threatened me when I moved here, right?

THOMAS

She wouldn't have done anything. Lydia is harmless. A crazy bitch, maybe, but a harmless one.

BETH

She broke into this flat less than a month ago.

THOMAS

She didn't kill anyone. Just broke a plate. That is *harmless*.

(CONTINUED)

Beth reaches into her pocket and tosses Thomas a sleek black SMARTPHONE, cracks webbed over the screen.

BETH

Found your phone, by the way. Those pictures Perri sent you are great. Perfect porn star material.

THOMAS

I can't control what other people send me. And you shouldn't go through my phone.

Beth rolls her eyes.

BETH

Maybe if you acted, even a little bit, like you had a girlfriend, Alexis wouldn't be a problem.

Beth leans against the counter, her eyes on a small collection of bottles; vodka, rum, tequila...

THOMAS

What the hell do you want me to do? Wear a fucking sign on my chest that says "property of Beth." Or no, maybe a tattoo would be better, ya know so I can't take it off.

Beth grabs a bottle and throws it at Thomas. He ducks and the bottle shatters against the wall, bits of glass raining over him.

Thomas shoves her back.

Beth slaps him across the face.

A still moment passes, the pair locked in place, staring at each other.

Beth steadies herself and walks from the room.

4

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

4

Beth shakes with fury as she shuts the door behind her, turning the lock. She pulls a suitcase from under the bed and chucks clothes inside, grabbing from the articles littered over the floor.

Her foot catches on the bed, mid-stride, and she falls to her knees. Her tear-filled eyes catch on a TICKET, to the London Eye in January, torn at the edges and creased down the middle.

5

EXT. THAMES RIVER SIDEWALK - NIGHT - FLASHBACK

5

Thomas and Beth walk with their arms linked and smiles wide. Both wear heavy jackets with winter hats, their breath visible in the air. In their free hands they carry styrofoam cups of mulled wine.

BETH

I can't believe I'm finally here.

THOMAS

So you do like it?

BETH

Of course! It's the coolest city ever! Though, I will admit, the Eye was a bit overpriced, for a giant ferris wheel.

She breaks away from him and leans over the railing. She points towards the other side of the river.

BETH

But look at those lights. There's actual life happening there.

Thomas gazes at her, his smile softening. He kisses her cheek and guides her back into step.

THOMAS

I guess it does have some charm.

Beth scoffs at him

BETH

You have some charm. London has *everything*.

THOMAS

I'm starting to think you're just using me to live here.

BETH

Oh I am definitely using you.

She wraps her arms around his waist, leaning into him.

BETH

You're incredibly warm.

The pair laugh and pick up their stride.

END FLASHBACK

6 INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

6

Beth still sits on the floor, tears rolling down her cheeks, staring at the ticket. She drags her fingernails down her arms leaving harsh jagged scratches over her skin.

7 EXT. APARTMENT LANDING - NIGHT

7

Lifted by a metal frame and wooden slats is the second story of the complex. The exterior light is brighter than any inside. Thomas leans on the railing, a lit cigarette between his lips.

ALLAN, late-20s, British, short with a goofy face and fierce build, walks up the metal steps.

ALLAN

Hey, Tom, what the hell? Your girlfriend takes off and you ditch the party?

He turns, fully facing Allan.

ALLAN

Shit, man. What the hell did she do to you?

THOMAS

She threw vodka at me.

He combs his fingers through his hair, knocking out bits of glass.

ALLAN

What did you do?

THOMAS

Nothing. Lydia saw me in Port's, caught me at the bar. She's looking for a stupid scarf, swears she left it here. Beth just freaked out over it.

ALLAN

Why bother with the girl, then? Is it the accent? Because if that's it, there are plenty of American girls arriving in the next few weeks, with Uni starting back up.

THOMAS

It's not the accent.

(CONTINUED)

He turns back to the railing, taking another drag from his cigarette.

ALLAN

That's why you don't pick up girls
on the internet.

THOMAS

It wasn't like that. We just
started talking and I really liked
what she was saying. She was
honest. I didn't plan on bringing
her to London, that
just...happened.

ALLAN

Then why did you?

Thomas flicks his cigarette away.

THOMAS

She wants to see the world and
experience anything she can.

ALLAN

What about you?

THOMAS

I want to see something other than
smoke covered streets and tourists
telling me how cute I am because I
say *chips*.

ALLAN

You love her?

THOMAS

Yeah, I do.

He's silent for a moment, his eyes now locked on the door to
his flat.

Allan clears his throat and checks his phone.

ALLAN

There's a party in Hammersmith,
that's a new one. You in?

THOMAS

It's four in the morning. Isn't
Hammersmith like thirty out?

(CONTINUED)

ALLAN
The others will be there. I bet
it'll be fun.

THOMAS
I should check on her.

8 INT. BEDROOM - LATER

8

The door is unlocked. Beth lays on the bed, curled under the duvet. Thomas enters and sees the suitcase, open on the floor with clothes spilling out.

THOMAS
Are you leaving?

BETH
No.

Thomas gets into bed.

THOMAS
Good.

He holds her, his fingers run over the scrapes on her arms.

THOMAS
I don't want you to leave.

BETH
Why do we do this?

THOMAS
Let's go on a trip.

Beth turns to look at him.

BETH
A trip?

THOMAS
I was thinking Belgium. Brussels is
a cool city. I have friends who've
gone. There's a pub there with over
two-thousands types of beer.

BETH
Is that even possible?

THOMAS
And waffles, you love waffles,
right? Where in the world is a
better place to get a waffle than
in Belgium?

(CONTINUED)

BETH

Thomas, what are you talking about?

He sits up, his hands still touching her.

THOMAS

We talked about traveling. All we've done is go up to Manchester and down to Brighton. Let's leave England. It doesn't cost much. We can go anywhere--everywhere. Let's just get out of this dingy flat and go somewhere.

BETH

Thomas...

THOMAS

We can't stay like this forever.

Beth stills for a moment, tensing at his words. With a slow exhale she sits up to face Thomas.

BETH

Okay. We'll go to Brussels. We'll eat waffles and chocolate and we'll drink over two-thousand types of beer. But right now, let's sleep.

THOMAS

I'm booking our tickets in the morning. We'll leave on Wednesday.

BETH

Wednesday it is.

The pair lie down again, closer than before.

THOMAS

We should go to Ireland next. You've always wanted to go to Dublin, right?

BETH

Sleep, Thomas. We'll talk in the morning.

FADE OUT